

## Grammar of Agency

This Glossary is the Rosetta Stone for the Grammar of Agency: it defines the core terms in a phenomenological way, in the moment of moral act, providing operators with a shared vocabulary for navigating those moral moments of act with clarity and integrity. CST/JPP lets operator navigate the ship in a chaotic world.

### Glossary of CST/JPP Terms

#### **Con + facere**

To make with, the moral moment is formed by not only the moral **Agent**, but by **Influencer(s)** (field), and by the **Witness**, who may or may not have a duty to testify, depending.

#### **Agent**

The human moral actor who performs *actus*.

Carries the vertical axis (faith, hope, love) and is solely responsible for action unless autonomy is overridden.

#### **Influencer**

Any force — person, system, structure, or context — that shapes the field in which the Agent acts.

Influences clarity, stability, and proportion but does not act in the **Agent's** place.

#### **Witness**

The tertiary evaluator who reads the **moral vector** of the moment.

The **Witness** testifies **only** when systemic disturbance threatens the **Agent's** autonomy.

If autonomy is intact, the **Witness** remains silent.

#### **Moral Vector**

The directional force created when the **Agent** acts within a field shaped by the Influencer and observed by the **Witness**.

Evaluated for **integrity**, not for judging the **Agent**.

## **Witness Moment**

The instant of *actus* when the Agent **penetrates the horizontal plane** and the vertical axis enters the world.

This is where the “wind hits the sail” — the spirit animates the action.  
The moment where action becomes testimony.

## **Actus**

The decisive, embodied action taken by the **Agent**.  
The hinge between intention and consequence.  
The only moment where agency is real.

## **CST Fourfold Test**

The altitude instrument that reveals what the moment is asking.  
A moment is evaluated by whether the contemplated action:

1. Restores human dignity
2. Seeds the common good
3. Strengthens sisterhood/brotherhood
4. Uplifts the little ones

This is the **operator’s manual for moments**.

## **JPP (Judgment-Premised Processing)**

The steering mechanism — a kata for navigating chaotic moments with clarity and proportion.

Not a system for judging people.

A discipline for **prudential praxis**.

## **Prudential Praxis**

Acting with direction, mindfulness, and purpose in the moment.  
Prudence operationalized as movement, not theory.

## Horizontal Plane (Virtue Matrix)

The stabilizing field of the four cardinal virtues:

- Prudence
- Justice
- Fortitude
- Temperance

This plane is **computationally legible** — an LLM can evaluate balance, proportion, and distortion.

## Vertical Axis (Transcendent Spine)

The human-only virtues:

- Faith
- Hope
- Love

These cannot be computed or automated.

They orient the Agent toward meaning, purpose, and moral depth.

### Keel

The grounding structure that keeps the **Agent** upright in turbulent conditions.  
Symbolizes the vertical virtues anchoring the craft.

### Sail

The receptive surface that catches the **Wind** (spirit).  
Represents the **Agent's** openness to meaning, purpose, and transcendent orientation.

### Wind

The animating force — the spirit, ruah, breath — that cannot be diagrammed.  
Reveals itself only in the **Witness Moment** when it hits the sail.

### Yoke / Harness

The constraint that preserves agency without domination.  
Keeps the **Agent** centered and prevents drift.

## **Stabilizers**

The balancing structures that prevent roll, pitch, and distortion.

**Horizontal stabilizers** = cardinal virtues Prudence, Temperance, Justice, Fortitude

Vertical stabilizers = transcendent virtues Faith, Hope, Love

## **Wu Wei Timing Belt**

The discipline of restraint.

Knowing when **not** to act, when to let the tea steep, when to allow the field to settle.

A core part of prudential praxis.

*Mantra: Let the tea steep. Gather seeds. Scent tea. Palm seeds. Breathe. Ground.*

## **Four Moves (Operator Sequence)**

1. **Frame** - take in the moment, self-awareness, field awareness, snapped in
2. **Receive + Sense** - actively passive
3. **Orient + Align** - framing with purpose and direction
4. **Act + Integrate** - now, in this moment, act. Assess, iterate. Stability provides closure: clean, no ripple left.

The repeatable kata that forms disposition through praxis.

## **Systemic Disturbance**

Any distortion in the field that threatens the **Agent's** autonomy:

coercion, manipulation, deception, structural injustice, emotional overwhelm, power imbalance.

Only under these conditions does the **Witness** testify.